



Minutes of the 23rd Central Facilities Committee (CFC) Meeting

The 23rd meeting of the CFC was held in the Boardroom at 11:30 AM on the 25th of November 2025.

It was attended by the following members:

Prof. Vivek Buwa, DDSP, Chairperson
Prof. Arvind Nema, DDO
Prof. Somnath Baidya Roy, Dean Planning
Prof. Ashwini Agrawal, Dean R&D
Prof. Amit Gupta, Associate Dean Infra (representing Dean Infrastructure)
Prof. Supreet Singh Bahga, Associate Dean PG Research
Prof. Ravikrishnan Elangovan, DBEB
Prof. Samaresh Das, CARE
Prof. Sameer Sapra, previous Head CRF
Prof. Manidipa Banerjee, Head CRF
Prof. Bhanu Nandan, Associate Head CRF

Prof. Nirat Ray from DMSE and Prof. P. K. Muduli from Dept of Physics could not attend the meeting because

of prior commitments.

The following agenda items were discussed:

Item 1. Updates on CRF usage: The Head and Associate Head CRF welcomed the newly constituted CFC and updated the committee about the usage of CRF by internal and external users. The number of users registered in CRF in the calendar year has crossed 8500, and the total CRF earnings from January 2025 was 1.24 crores.

The DDSP noted that while CRF will continue to receive support from the institute for manpower, capital assets as required by the IITD researchers and infrastructural needs; the earnings of CRF should be utilized for consumables and contingency costs. The DDSP assured that funds required over and above the earnings will be provided by the institute. These expenditures must be approved by the CRF Operations Committee and also the Institute Budget Allocation Committee.

The Head CRF mentioned that 92 publications in 2025 have acknowledged CRF, and the actual number of publications from IITD that utilize CRF/SATFI should be much higher, and the committee concurred. The Head CRF suggested that it may be possible to provide technical awards to the best publications, as a means to correct underreporting. The CFC noted that correct reporting is essential irrespective of an award mechanism, and suggested that the submission of publication statistics be made mandatory prior to re-registering of institute users every year.

Item 2. Alterations in CRF operations: Head and Associate Head CRF apprised the CFC about the recent alterations in operations. The day-to-day operations are now overseen by an operations committee that takes decisions on manpower, infrastructural and equipment-related issues. The CFC appreciated the step and



suggested that all budget requirements also be discussed and validated in the Operations Committee to ensure transparency. The Head CRF concurred that budgeting will be one of the main responsibilities of the Operations committee, which consists of Prof S Nagendran (Chemistry), Prof Jayant Jain (DMSE), Prof Pankaj Srivastava (Physics), Prof Amit Gupta (Mechanical Engineering), Prof Manjesh Kumar (Chemical Engineering), Prof Jatin Panwar (DBEB), Head and Associate Head CRF. The Operations Committee also has special invitees including student and staff representatives and the DR IRD Accounts.

The CFC was further appraised about the planned alterations in staff duties in the Hauz Khas and Sonipat facilities. The operators have been assigned to multiple machines and will be rotated periodically to ensure continuous data collection in cases of staff attrition and to ensure upskilling within the system. The CFC concurred that this is a necessary step to ensure smooth operations.

The Dean Planning suggested that since the staff are highly skilled (~45% with PhDs), their experience and knowledge may be utilized by the institute in the context of training and publications. The Head and Associate Head CRF were asked to devise a mode by which the operators may be provided some time to carry on their own research and contribute to publications, without affecting CRF operations or earnings. The CFC also suggested that the staff may contribute to workshops without affecting data collection slots. Prof Elangovan, DBEB suggested that CRF facilities may be aligned with the CEP of the institute to ensure all equipment and staff are optimally utilized. A proposal in this regard was requested from CRF. The CFC agreed that some of these initiatives may be essential to retain highly trained and specialized manpower.

Item 3. Increase in HRA: The CFC discussed the issue of proposed HRA increase to 30% for all CRF staff. It was decided that since CRF staff are hired through the IIT Delhi main campus, and their duties are to be rotated among facilities in both Hauz Khas and Sonipat, their HRA may be increased to 30% as per prevailing norms regardless of current place of primary duty.

The meeting ended with a vote of thanks to the Chair.

Prof. Manidipa Banerjee

Head CRF

Copy to:

All CFC members

Chairman, CFC (DD S&P)

Prof. Vivek V. Buwa

Director (for approval)

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